

Which conceptual model is best?

- Direct manipulation is good for 'doing' types of tasks, e.g. designing, drawing, flying, driving, sizing windows
- Issuing instructions is good for repetitive tasks, e.g. spell-checking, file management
- Having a conversation is good for children, computer-phobic, disabled users and specialised applications (e.g. phone services)
- Hybrid conceptual models are often employed, where different ways of carrying out the same actions is supported at the interface - but can take longer to learn

Conceptual models: interaction and interface

- Interaction type:
 - what the user is doing when interacting with a system, e.g. instructing, talking, browsing or other
- Interface type:
 - the kind of interface used to support the mode, e.g. speech, menu-based, gesture

Many kinds of interface types available including...

- Command
- Speech
- Data-entry
- Form fill-in
- Query
- Graphical
- Web
- Pen
- Augmented reality
- Gesture

Which interaction type to choose?

- Need to determine requirements and user needs
- Take budget and other constraints into account
- Also will depend on suitability of technology for activity being supported
- This is covered in course when designing conceptual models